

Information Sheet

Invitation to Take Part

Thank you for considering to take part in this study that aims at deepening our understanding of human perception. This study is being conducted by Oliver Collins and Dr. Dominique Makowski from the **University of Sussex**, who are happy to be contacted if you have any questions (see contact information below).

Why have I been invited and what will I do?

The goal is to investigate how our brains can unconsciously adapt and shape our perception to achieve desired goals. In this experiment, you will complete the **Illusion Game** - a task of speed and reflex in which you will need to make judgements whilst resisting different visual illusions. You will also be presented with other cognitive tasks and some questionnaires, in which you will be asked questions about your personality, habits, and physical sensations that you typically experience in various settings, such as during stress, sexual activity, or at rest. The whole experiment will take roughly **90-120 mins** to complete, from setting up physiological sensors to the debriefing.

Do I have to take part?

Your participation is entirely voluntary. You are free to choose not to take part, or to withdraw at any stage without having to give a reason and without being penalised in any way. If you choose to take part, you will be asked to provide your consent electronically before starting the study. As we are not collecting any personally identifiable information, it will not be possible to withdraw your data after you submit it. You will be reimbursed with at least **8 SONA credits** for your participation. An experiment duration over 1 hour 30 mins, rounded to the nearest 15 mins, will result in extra credits being granted (i.e., experiment duration of 2 hours = 10 credits).

Physiological Signals

We will be recording some of your body's electrical activity using ECG and EEG; both are simple non-intrusive procedures used in research and in the life sciences. Since this study is being undertaken for research purposes only, we will not be able to provide any feedback or information on clinical aspects of the data obtained. For the ECG we will be attaching some sensors to the skin, and for the EEG we will be using the Muse headset which contains electrodes that will be placed on your forehead and behind the ears. We kindly ask that you refrain from participating if you are aware of having skin reactions or allergies to adhesives or the materials used in the electrodes - primarily composed of silver and silver chloride.

What will happen to the results and my personal information?

The results of this research will be disseminated in an Undergraduate Research Dissertation and may be written into a scientific publication. Data collected may be used in future research projects. Your anonymity will be ensured in the way described in the consent information below. **Please read this information carefully** and then, if you wish to take part, please acknowledge that you have fully understood this sheet, and that you consent to take part in the study as it is described here.

Who has approved this study?

This study has been approved by the Faculty Research Ethics Committee: Science, Engineering and Technology, and the project Review Reference is 2026-2040-2536.

Insurance

The University of Sussex has insurance in place to cover its legal liabilities in respect of this study.

Contact for Further Information

For further information about this research, or if you have any concerns, please contact Dr. Dominique Makowski (D.Makowski@sussex.ac.uk), Oliver Collins (oc236@sussex.ac.uk). If you have any concerns about the way in which the study has been conducted, you should contact the SEMSET Faculty Research Ethics Committee at frecsemset@sussex.ac.uk.